

Project 2: Mapping an Experience

Anya Krishnamony, Abby Miu, Maya Hong, Viraj Aggarwal

ARTF 1250: Designing Interactive Experiences

November 3, 2025

Brainstorming, Research & Observations

Observing Curry

- Focused on 3 different areas: food court, upper floor, and outside (Snell Library Quad)

Location 1: Food Court

- Actions: Mostly working on assignments or just chatting and eating
- Conversations/Relationships: People sitting with friends, suitemates, teammates for group projects, or by themselves
- Moods: Excited, calm, happy, busy, studious, lonely

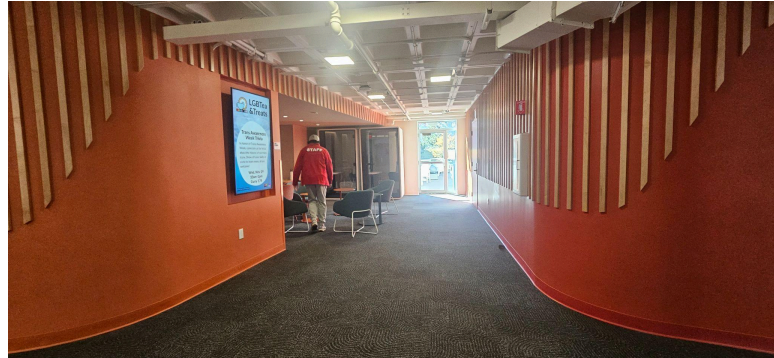
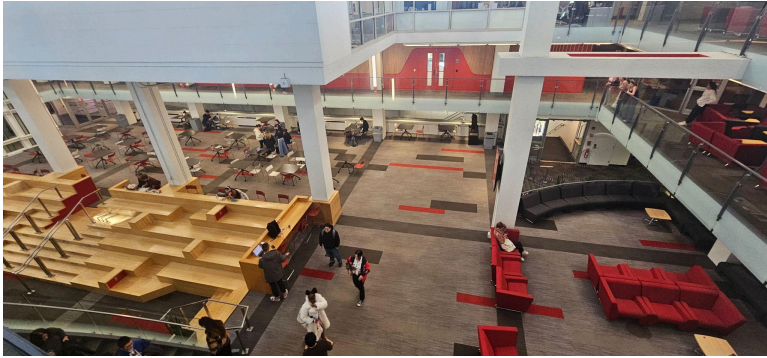
Location 2: Upper Floor

- Actions: People on phones, doing work, on laptops messaging, on facetime, eating, working on presentations, classrooms full of students learning something, group of students holding flowers (maybe celebrating something), walking and listening to music with coffees in hand, rushing to get to a certain place
- Conversations/Relationships: Most conversations are between roommates and suitemates
- Moods: Happy/cheerful vibe, studious (quiet and focused on work), busy, chill/casual

Location 3: Outside Curry (Snell Library Quad)

- Actions: Exclusively walking (not many people sitting around), either by themselves or alone, around 60-70% with headphones in (but not all listening to music, some on calls)
- Conversations/Relationships: No more than 3 people walking together, very engaged in their conversations
- Moods: Distracted, energetic (walking with determination to get somewhere), calm/peaceful, tired, productive

Photos



Mapping Brainstorm

Topic Ideas

- Want to track movement: focusing on areas where walking is more prevalent
- How people walking in groups, pairs, individual affects identity
- Songs people listen to (by genre) and how they're feeling on two different/contrasting days- do certain songs influence emotion or does emotion influence songs picked?
- People with beverages in hand at different times of day - what types of beverages, temperature, colors, etc.
- Conversations had in a certain area

Mapping details

- Colors representing emotion
- Simple sketches representing tasks
- Different fonts for different days of the week
- Different direction of lines for different days
- Mood (colors)
- Song/Genre (direction)

Final Topic: Mapping Music Genres and Feelings Across Contrasting Days

Potential Questions

- Do certain music genres correlate with certain emotional states?
- Is the emotional mood more affected by the music chosen or the environment and time of day?
- How do emotional expressions differ when students listen to music alone (with headphones) versus interacting with friends?

Data Collection Process

- Ask people walking through the area two things:
 - What song they are currently listening to
 - How does it makes them feel
- Focus on two days/timeframes: Friday afternoon/evening (Halloween) and Sunday morning
- Classify songs by set genre groups and emotion groups
- Map locations where students gather and listen to specific genres and feelings

Goals

- To create an unconventional map that reveals the emotional and musical setting of the quad

- Depict how music and mood are represented in everyday life, especially with students
- To see how different environments and timing influence what we listen to and our emotions

Data Collection - Songs & Emotions

Friday October 31, 2025

4:00 PM - 4:15 PM

Cloudy, 40*

Name of Song + Artist	Genre	Emotion/Feeling
I Put A Spell On You - Annie Lennox	Rock	Powerful
CLOVER - Cannelle	Indie / Alternative	Happy
Follow God - Kanye West	Hip-Hop / R&B	Energetic
Stateside - PinkPantheress	Hip-Hop / R&B	Energetic
Bloody Mary - Lady Gaga	Pop / Alt Pop	Powerful
Message in a Bottle - Oscar blue	Indie / Alternative	Sad
Santa - Rvssian	Global / International	Energetic
White cat - Yves	K-Pop / Dance Pop	Happy
Mona Lisa - Dominic Fike	Indie / Alternative	Happy
Mr Rager - Kid Cudi	Hip-Hop / R&B	Energetic
Mad About You - Hooverphonic	Indie / Alternative	Energetic
R u ok? - ifeye	K-Pop / Dance Pop	Energetic
Circadian Rhythm - Drake	Hip-Hop / R&B	Happy
Glory Pox - Portishead	Rock	Powerful
Glitter - lexycat	Indie / Alternative	Energetic

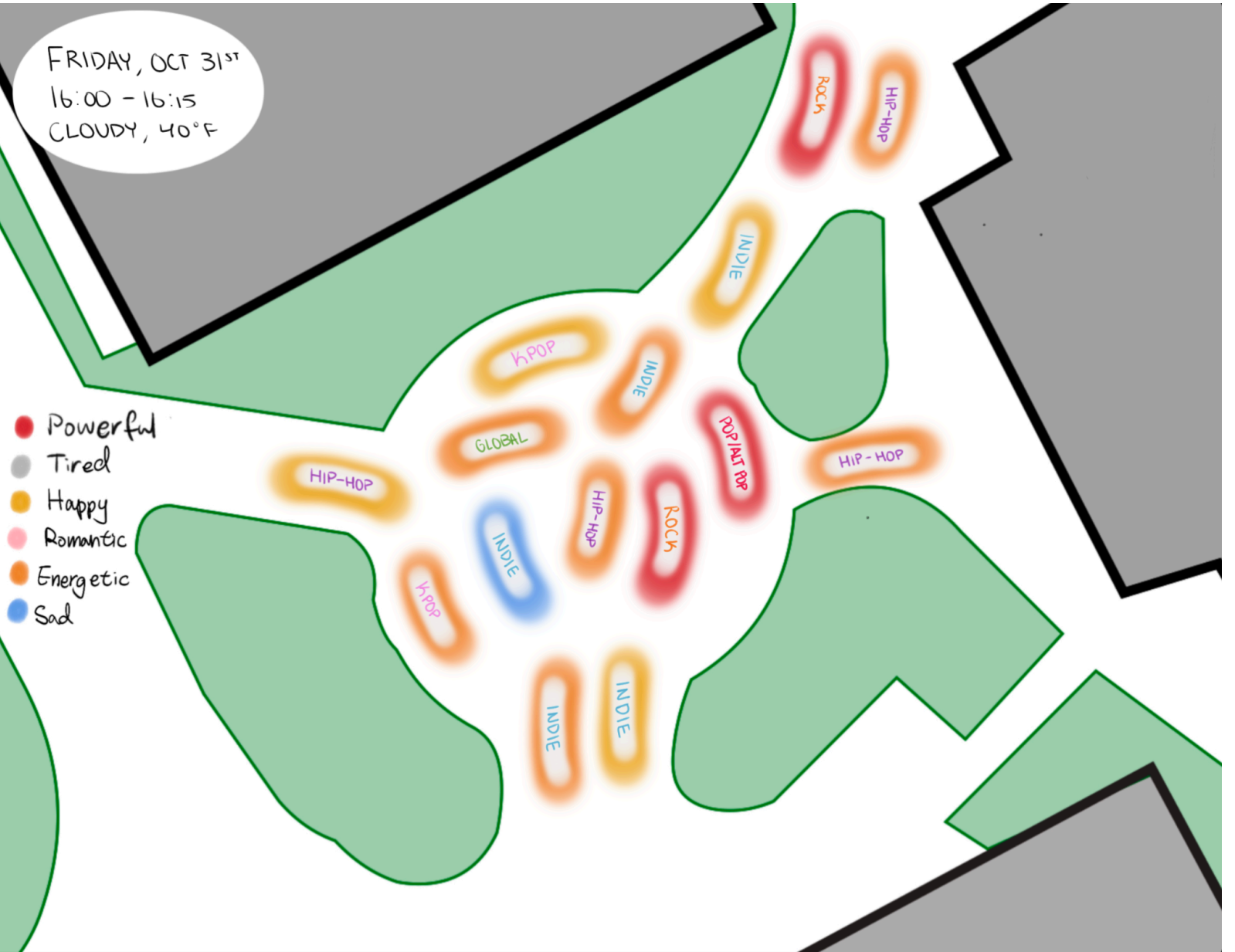
Sunday November 2, 2025

1:00 PM - 1:15 PM

Sunny, 59*

Name of Song + Artist	Genre	Emotion/Feeling
Sex is Powerful - MARINA	Pop / Alt Pop	Powerful
Into It - Chase Atlantic	Pop / Alt Pop	Tired
Titi Me Pregunto - Bad Bunny	Global / International	Happy
Feel Like A Stranger - Grateful Dead	Indie / Alternative	Energetic
Past Lives - sapientdream	Indie / Alternative	Happy
Rodrick Rules - Malcolm Todd	Indie / Alternative	Happy
Vaaroon - Anand Bhaskar	Global / International	Romantic
In my head - Ariana Grande	Pop / Alt Pop	Powerful
Pt. 2 - Kanye West	Hip-Hop / R&B	Energetic
Young Dumb and Broke - Khalid	Pop / Alt Pop	Happy
Savior Complex - Phoebe Bridgers	Indie / Alternative	Sad
Ditto - NewJeans	K-Pop / Dance Pop	Happy
Drama - Aespa	K-Pop / Dance Pop	Energetic
Blue - PinkPantheress	Indie / Alternative	Energetic
Location - Playboi Carti	Hip-Hop / R&B	Happy

Final Maps



SUNDAY, NOV 2ND

13:00 - 13:15

SUNNY, 59°F

- Powerful
- Tired
- Happy
- Romantic
- Energetic
- Sad



Reflection

As you record information to create your map, consider the visual design (layout, typography, map key if any required etc.) of your map and the overall experience of looking at, interpreting and using the map. After completing the mapping exercise, reflect on and respond to the below questions (1 paragraph each) as a team.

What did you decide to map and why?

We decided to map the Snell Library Quad located just outside the Curry Student Center as we realised that it gets the most foot traffic, whether people are commuting between home and campus using the T or visiting the library between classes. We expected this area to be where people would be mostly walking by at busy times of the day. This space offers a natural setting to observe different behaviour. We also figured that when people are walking, they usually listen to music at that time and aren't focused on work or class at that moment as compared to if they were sitting down and working. This could suggest that emotions are more easily identifiable and range across different categories. We specifically focused on the songs people were listening to and their moods/emotions because we wanted to explore the relationship between music and emotion in a public setting.

Whose story are you telling with your map and whose story are you not telling?

The story we are telling are the students of Northeastern and their daily routine based on their mood as expressed through their music choices on contrasting days. We picked two different days (Friday and Sunday) that we thought would have the biggest contrast. Friday (Halloween) is a day to celebrate finishing the week and getting ready for the exciting weekend, while Sunday is focused on resetting for the upcoming week and is considered a day of rest and relaxation. This essentially captures how students' emotional states and music preferences shift between a festive evening and a quiet weekend morning. It also depicts the relationship between specific genres and emotional feelings. The Snell Quad is located on Northeastern University Campus grounds, and so the range of people does not reach the general population, like those going to work, people going to school, etc. It is limited to primarily Northeastern students. This map also excludes people who aren't listening to music or weren't comfortable with sharing their song choices with us.

What problems and opportunities does looking at the NU campus/neighborhood/Boston through your map reveal to us?

By creating this map, it can reveal what the general mood is of the community based on the day or the time of day. Every student has their own business they need to attend and so by getting

the genre of music they are listening to we can understand what students feel or how busy they are based on the time of day.